

FIT5057 Project Management

Semester 2, 2025

Assignment One

Due Dates:

- **Written submission (70%):** Week 7, Friday 12 September 2025, 11:55 PM
- **The Pitch (10%):** During week 4 applied classes.
- **Group demonstration (20%):** During week 6 applied classes.

Value: 40% of overall unit assessment

Mode of Submission: Online via Moodle; In-Class demonstration.

OVERVIEW

- This is primarily a group assignment. There are a few individual tasks included.
- You will prepare project plans and documentation for a project.
- Your proposed project should meet the client's business objectives and requirements.

This document outlines the objectives, requirements, and expectations for each part of the assignment. It also provides guidance on project selection, budget planning, cost estimation, and project management methodologies to help students successfully complete their submissions.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Through this assignment you will:

- Learn and demonstrate your analytical and project management skills;
- Develop your skills in communicating project characteristics and business justification;
- Develop a clear project charter that addresses one of the new IT-focused project options.
- Define a precise project scope and quality plan that meets your project goals.
- Develop detailed work breakdown structures and cost and scheduling documents.
- Develop Quality and risk management plans and related documents for a given project.
- Develop stakeholder and communication management plans.
- Apply PMBOK guidelines and modern project management methods

GETTING HELP

If you have any questions or concerns, you can:

- Consult with your TAs during applied classes and workshops;
- Attend consultation sessions (see Moodle for details);
- **Ask a question in the [EdForum](#).**

SUBMISSION INSTRUCTIONS

- Your assignment must take the form of **a single PDF document**.
- You should name your document file as <<A1>>_<<team number>>.pdf, where <<A1>> is Assignment 1 and <<team number>> is the unique team number assigned to your team in Moodle. For example, a file name could be A1_0325.pdf, where the team number is '0325'.

Draft files should be submitted otherwise the file will not be marked.

One team member uploads the file into draft mode. ALL team members have to accept the student statement and submit for the file to be considered submitted.

DEMONSTRATION INSTRUCTIONS

1. Each team is required to demonstrate the Gantt chart (task 3.4) developed for their project, together with a reflective review of the team's collaborative approach in developing work breakdown structures and Gantt charts, to their tutors during their allocated applied classes that occur in week 6.
2. Your tutors will book a time for your team's demonstration during applied classes and communicate the time to you.
3. All team members are expected to participate in the demonstrations;
4. You will receive verbal feedback on your demonstration, and your assessment of the task is entirely based on the demonstration.
5. You **can not** request short extensions for the demonstration tasks.

The Pitch INSTRUCTIONS

1. Each team is required to pitch their project idea to the class, during their allocated applied classes that occur in week 4.
2. Your tutors will book a time for your team's demonstration during applied classes and communicate the time to you.
3. All team members are expected to contribute to the pitch; Your pitch can take up to ONE minute.
4. This task will be assessed by your tutors AND fellow students.
5. You **can not** request short extensions for the pitch.

PLAGIARISM DECLARATION

When uploading your assignment on Moodle, you are required to accept the Student Statement (which includes a declaration that you have not plagiarised during the preparation of your assignment solution). You are required to ACCEPT the Student Statement; otherwise, you will not be able to submit your assignment electronically and your assignment will NOT be assessed.

GENERATIVE AI

AI & Generative AI tools may be used SELECTIVELY within this assessment. Where used, AI must be used responsibly, clearly documented and appropriately acknowledged (see [Learn HQ](#)).

Any work submitted for a mark must:

- represent a sincere demonstration of your human efforts, skills and subject knowledge that you will be accountable for.
- adhere to the guidelines for AI use set for the assessment task.
- reflect the University's commitment to academic integrity and ethical behaviour.

Inappropriate AI use and/or AI use without acknowledgement will be considered a breach of academic integrity.

LATE SUBMISSION

1. Submission must be made by the due date. Unless an extension or special consideration has been granted, or otherwise specified in the learning management system, students who submit an assessment task after the due date will receive a late-submission penalty of 5 percent of the available marks in that task. A further penalty of 5 percent of the available marks will be applied for each additional day (24-hour period), or part thereof, the assessment task is overdue.
2. If you cannot complete an assessment (due to exceptional circumstances beyond your control), you may be eligible for a short extension or special consideration. A short extension is two calendar days and is available once for each eligible assessment. The first short extension for a unit will be granted without a reason given. All subsequent extensions require a reason when the application is submitted. Special consideration is a longer extension (for

more than two days). Eligible students must supply a reason and supporting documentation.

3. For more details of the Special Consideration procedure and rules, and how to apply, visit:
<https://www.monash.edu/students/admin/exams/changes/special-consideration>

1. Assignment overview

Assignment deliverables, weight and related teaching weeks in the semester

Project lifecycle Phase	Deliverable	Related teaching period	Weight	Purpose
1. Team Setup	TeamWorking Agreement	Week 3 (NO SUBMISSION REQUIRED)	5%	Agree on team roles, goals, rules, and conflict handling
2. Initiating	Business Justification, Project Charter and memo	Week 4 (NO SUBMISSION REQUIRED))	15%	Define project need, objectives, scope, risks, and constraints
	One-Minute Pitch	Week 4 (In class)	10%	Present idea clearly and persuasively
3. Planning	Scope	Week 5 (NO SUBMISSION REQUIRED)	10%	Document what's in/out, assumptions, requirements
	Schedule (WBS + Gantt)	Week 6 (Demo)	20%	Show task breakdown, timelines, milestones with live presentation
	Cost Model & Baseline	Week 6 (NO SUBMISSION REQUIRED)	8%	Estimate costs, justify budget, add optional baseline chart
4. Governance	Risk	Week 6 (NO SUBMISSION REQUIRED)	8%	Identify risks, plan responses, include heatmap
	Quality Management Plan	Week 7	8%	Set quality targets and explain how you'll measure and manage quality
	Stakeholder & Communication Plan	Week 7	5%	Identify key people, map communication strategies
5. Wrap-up	Compiled Project documents	Week 7 (Written submission due on 12 Sep)	-	Integrate all deliverables into a formal proposal document, add the group and individual reflections, review completeness, correctness and clarity of statement and finalise your reference list and in-text citations.
	Group Reflection	Week 7	3%	Review team collaboration against the agreement
	Individual Reflection	Week 7	3%	Evaluate your own contribution using a reflective model. Evaluate your team.
	Complete, correct and clear statements	N/A	2%	Review completeness, correctness and clarity of statements in the report.
	Use of references	N/A	3%	Review and finalise your reference list and in-text citations.

2. Context

Monash University is undertaking a bold and complex Campus Digitisation Initiative aimed at transforming its digital infrastructure, learning environments, and sustainability practices. However, the initiative is facing strategic tension:

- Funding constraints due to shifting government priorities.
- Stakeholder misalignment across faculties and departments.
- Past project failures have led to increased scrutiny and demand for measurable impact.

Your consulting firm has been engaged to design and plan a digital IT project that supports one of Monash's strategic pillars and contributes to the initiative's success despite these challenges.

2.1 Your Role

You represent a start-up consulting firm contracted by Monash University to support the planning phase of a strategic IT project under the Campus Digitisation Initiative. Your responsibilities include:

- Selecting and justifying a project option that aligns with Monash's strategic goals and addresses current challenges.
- Collaborating with stakeholders to define scope, deliverables, constraints, and assumptions while navigating conflicting priorities.
- Creating detailed planning artefacts, including a project charter, work breakdown structure (WBS), Gantt chart, and cost estimate.
- Identifying and managing risks, quality standards, and stakeholder communication strategies.
- Working as a team to produce high-quality deliverables that demonstrate strategic alignment, feasibility, and critical thinking.

Your project must be feasible within a \$500,000 budget and a duration of maximum 16 months, and must reflect the realities of operating in a complex, high-stakes university environment.

2.2 Your Client

Monash University's Campus Digitisation Initiative is a multi-year transformation program designed to create a digitally empowered campus community. The initiative is directly aligned with the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) and focuses on the following strategic pillars:

The digitisation initiative centres on two strategic pillars aligned to key SDGs:

1. *Digital Education (SDG 4)*

Expand access and deploy advanced digital platforms to improve teaching, learning, and assessment, aiming for a 10% rise in online engagement and course completion within 18 months.

Example of projects include:

Enhancing Assessment Feedback Through Gamified Peer Engagement: PolyMentor is an integrated digital feedback platform that builds on the analytics foundation of PolyFeed, adding structured and gamified peer-to-peer feedback features. It enables students and

educators to track and act on both instructor and peer assessment feedback, supporting engagement through badges, progress milestones, and interactive prompts that encourage regular participation and reflection. By combining PolyFeed's insights with new qualitative data from peer interactions, PolyMentor creates a dynamic feedback culture that advances continuous engagement, enhances feedback literacy, and strengthens learning outcomes across educational communities. You can find more information about PolyFeed here: <https://www.polyfeed.com.au/>

Enhancing Education through AI-powered Learning Agents with Lecturer Supervision: This project seeks to enhance educational experiences by incorporating AI-powered learning agents as customised learning support for units, to support lecturers in running active, engaging classes. The AI agents, designed for supporting in-class activities, will be trained on the unit's content and theories, and can give clear activity instructions, clarify terms and requirements, provide rapid feedback, and enable lecturers to focus on building relationships with students and teams to help their progress and offer expert support where needed. This 'co-teaching' approach ensures that the AI 'frees up' time for lecturer-student engagement (rather than replacing the lecturer) by efficiently clarifying basics and task processes, helping learning activities run smoothly, and keeping the human element of teaching central, for a more effective and inclusive educational environment.

2. Climate & Sustainability Stewardship (SDGs 11, 13)

Adopt IT solutions for campus energy efficiency and environmental monitoring, targeting a 15% reduction in emissions.

Example of projects include:

Campus Electrification Analytics for Sustainable Planning: This project will leverage advanced IT applications to elevate the effectiveness of campus electrification initiatives in support of the Net Zero agenda. Through robust data collection and analysis, the platform will monitor the integration of renewable energy sources, track patterns of electricity consumption, and identify opportunities for efficiency improvements. Scenario modeling tools will enable resilient, long-term campus planning by assessing the impacts of various electrification strategies. Stakeholder-specific dashboards will support both operational staff and the campus community, providing accessible, up-to-date information on emissions reduction progress, thereby fostering informed participation in sustainability efforts.

Measuring the Environmental Footprint of AI Usage for Monash Educators & Students: This project will develop the EcoAI app, an easy-to-use digital platform for Monash University educators and students to calculate and understand the environmental footprint of their AI-based activities. The app will estimate carbon, water, and energy consumption from various AI tools, including generative models and large language models, closely aligning with Monash's Net Zero goals and ongoing sustainability initiatives. Utilising real-time input on user interactions and leveraging benchmarks (such as the estimated 4.32g CO₂ emitted per query for large models), EcoAI will reveal the cumulative eco-impact of AI use while offering actionable suggestions to minimise emissions, like favoring renewable-powered computation, reducing usage where possible, and opting for lighter AI tools. The platform will feature dashboards for both individuals and courses, promoting transparency around AI's climate

costs and helping the Monash community integrate sustainability into digital learning and research practices.

2.3 Choosing Your Project Strategic Pillars and SDG Alignment

Your team must design a project that clearly supports one of the strategic pillars. In your submission, you must:

- Select one primary pillar that your project supports
- Link your project clearly to the relevant SDG(s)
- Explain how your project helps Monash achieve its goals

3. Assignment Breakdown

Task 3.1 The Working Agreement (written submission)

Team forming activities have commenced from week 1 during the applied classes. Everyone is expected to collaborate with their peers in the classroom and form teams of 3 - 4 members within their applied class. Those who are not present in the class and do not take part in the process will not be assigned to a team and are expected to work individually without any adjustments to the workload.

A Working Agreement template is available for you to use for this task. Assignment teams have been primarily established since week 1, and the remaining teams will be established during weeks 2 and 3 applied classes. After establishing a team, students should develop a Working Agreement addressing their objectives, their approach to working as a team, their plans for communications and meetings, their approach to conflict resolution (e.g., disagreements, team member absences, poor performance by team members), and what the team policy will be for communication and collaboration to create a high performing team. The team leader should also be nominated in the charter (the team leader will later oversee the team's progress and ensure the team's performance is on track).

3.2 The Project initiation

Objective: Develop a submission that starts with a clear Business Justification, followed by a detailed Project Charter. The justification explains why the project is needed, while the charter details how it will be executed.

Instructions: Select a project that is aligned with one of the strategic pillars of the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).

Task 3.2.1 Develop Business Justification for your project (written submission)

Develop the Business Justification and include

- Strategic Alignment: Explain how the project supports Monash University's mission and strategic priorities in support of the targeted UN Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).
- Current Situation and Problem/Opportunity Statement: Discuss how and why the current situation, as mentioned in the case, presents an opportunity/problem for the portfolio. Demonstrate the contribution of the project to the value delivery system of the client's organisation;
- Describe project deliverables including characteristics of the product and project outcomes.
- A reflection on any ethical implications of the project or product. You will find resources in Moodle to enhance your understanding of ethics in project management
- **Distinction/High Distinction task** (for students pursuing D/HD): Include a detailed Cost-Benefit Analysis (estimated costs vs. anticipated benefits).
 - Identify and Categorise Costs
 - Outline both financial and strategic benefits
 - Net Present Value (NPV) Calculation/ Return on Investment (ROI)
 - Provide a clear conclusion on whether the project is financially justified or primarily driven by strategic value.
 - NOTE: Incorporate a recommended discount rate with reference (e.g., 5-10%) for NPV calculations. - Provide a cost-benefit table with NPV calculations.

Task 3.2.2 Develop a Project Charter (written submission)

Develop a Project Charter, including the following

- Project Title and Description: Provide a concise statement of the project's purpose and scope.
- Project Objectives: List specific objectives aligned with project goals and the relevant UN SDGs.
- Project start and finish dates
- High level project budget information.
- Project manager's name and contact information.
- Main Project Success Criteria
- Project development approach
- Key stakeholders and their roles in the organisation and in the project.

Key Considerations

- Avoid overlapping content between the business justification and the project charter.
- The Business Justification provides the rationale for the project, explaining why it is necessary and how it aligns with Monash University's strategic priorities.
- The Project Charter focuses on defining and structuring the project, outlining its key components and execution plan.

Task 3.2.3 Present The Pitch (presentation in week 4 applied)

Each team is to deliver a pitch of your business justification in up to ONE minute during your allocated applied classes in week 4.

This task will be assessed by your tutors and fellow students based on the following criteria:

- **Engagement:** How well you capture and maintain the audience's attention.
- **Clarity:** The ease with which your ideas are understood.
- **Persuasiveness:** How convincing your business justification is.
- **Relevance:** How well your pitch aligns with the goals and objectives of the project.
- **Delivery:** The confidence, professionalism, and effectiveness of your presentation style.

You should assume that the audience in the room are your stakeholders and client representatives. Your objective is to communicate your proposed project and persuade them to approve your project. You can assume that other teams are your competitors and you are all trying to convince your stakeholders that they should choose your project as the winner.

Task 3.2.4 Write a memo (written submission)

This 1-page memo is addressed to a hypothetical project sponsor (e.g., CIO or Faculty Director). It must briefly describe your project, its value to the university, and any known risks. You could reflect on the feedback and responses you received from your pitch to the stakeholders.

Your memo should include the following sections:

- **To/From/Date/Subject:** Use a standard memo format.
- **Executive Summary:** A brief overview of your proposed project and its relevance to the client's mission.
- **Project Description:** A clear explanation of the project idea, including its purpose, key features, and target users.
- **Strategic Fit:** Explain how the project aligns with the client's current initiatives, values, and goals.
- **Proposed Scope of Work:** Outline the major phases of the project (e.g., planning, design, development, testing, launch).
- **Team Composition & Methodology:** Describe the roles needed and the project management approach (e.g., hybrid, agile, waterfall).
- **Estimated Timeline & Budget:** Provide a high-level estimate of how long the project will take and how the budget will be allocated.
- **Risk Analysis:** Identify potential risks and how they will be mitigated.
- **Conclusion and recommendation:** Summarise the benefits and invite the client to move forward with the proposal.

* Note: Your memo and project Charter cover similar items however the language and audience of the two are different . Memo should be concise, easy to read and include a reflection from your pitch.

3.3 Project Scope (written submission)

Develop a comprehensive scope for your project. This will provide the basis for all of your project decisions, estimations and assumptions. Your scope should be clear and comprehensive, so it can be easily and effectively communicated with the project stakeholders.

Task 3.3.1 Develop a requirements traceability matrix (RTM) for your product. The RTM should include at least ten requirements for your product, identifying whether they are functional or non-functional. Include any assumptions made, requirement categories, sources and their latest status.

* Notes: You should develop requirements that are directly about **your product**. You can make the assumption that some of the requirements have been discussed with the client and they are the **source** of the requirement

Task 3.3.2 Develop a scope statement of up to **800 words** for your project. You should address all criteria in the template and as follows.

- a. Define the overall purpose, boundaries, and major deliverables of the project. Explain why the project is needed and what it aims to achieve
- b. Add a list of at least 5 key Deliverables. For each Deliverable, include
 - i. A minimum of 3 functional requirements and their Acceptance criteria. Establish clear, measurable acceptance criteria under which the deliverables will be accepted by stakeholders.
 - ii. A minimum of 3 non-functional requirements and their Acceptance criteria. Establish clear, measurable acceptance criteria under which the deliverables will be accepted by stakeholder
- c. Out of Scope & Exclusions: List the specific features, functions, and activities that are excluded from your scope to prevent scope creep.
- d. Constraints & Assumptions: Identify any limitations (such as budget, timeline, or technology restrictions) that will impact the project. State the key assumptions underpinning your plan and how you will validate them.

3.4 Develop Work Breakdown structure and Project schedule

The evaluation of this will take place within team demonstrations scheduled during your allocated applied class in weeks 6. **The marks awarded from your demonstration will constitute the final grade for this section.** Without the demonstrations in the applied classes, the maximum grade your submitted work could achieve is a pass or equivalent to 50% of the task's available score.

→ This section is assessed entirely based on your Week 6 in-class demonstration. You must also include a screenshot in your final report.

Step 1 Develop a work breakdown structure (WBS) for your project up to Level 3 or Level 4 (as appropriate) in a list or tabular format. The WBS should be consistent with the project charter and scope statement.

Step 2 Develop a Gantt chart for your project.

Based on the scope, schedule, and cost goals of your project, you should now develop a schedule management plan for your individual project in the form of a Gantt chart.

Your project plan should be consistent with your project charter and scope statements. Remember that the Maximum time available for the project is 16 months. It is your responsibility to develop a schedule that is achievable given the constraints of available resources, budget/ cost, and scope.

Use ProjectLibre, Project Planner (MS Project), Smartsheet, Primavera or any other suitable software with the capability of depicting Gantt charts with milestones, precedence, duration, and critical paths to develop a Gantt chart and assign preliminary dependencies and sequences. Spreadsheets and/or other productivity software are not acceptable to use for this task.

Step 3 Identify at least Eight milestones for your project, with justification for their timing and precedence. Use the SMART criteria to make sure the milestones are suitable for your project. (Hint: project start and end dates are not the best choices for this task!)

Step 4 Add the Eight milestones identified in the previous step to the Gantt chart in the correct presentation, and make sure the milestones have relevant dependencies. Note that milestones represent points in time and should not include durations.

Step 5 Gantt chart demonstration: This is a team activity that requires your collective efforts and collaboration. **Your presentation will take place during Week 6 applied classes, with your supervising tutor present to evaluate the demonstration.**

The team will demonstrate their complete Gantt Chart and reflections from the process to their supervising tutors during the applied classes in weeks 6. Each demonstration can take **up to 9 minutes**.

- The demonstration should address these criteria:

-
- Does the Gantt chart accurately depict tasks, dependencies, durations. and milestones? Is it logical and feasible?
 - How well did the team justify their task durations, dependencies and milestones?
 - How effectively did the team work together, share feedback, and support each other during the demonstration?
 - Does the team's reflection demonstrate a deep understanding of the project management processes and lessons learned?
 - Was the presentation clear, well-organised, and finished within the allocated time?
-

Each group is required to include one screenshot of the Gantt chart that they have created for their Project in the main body of their written submission. The screenshot should show the task

descriptions, timeline, flow of the tasks, dependencies, and milestones. This is to make your report cohesive and as evidence of your demonstrated work in class. In exceptional circumstances, this part of the report may be assessed independently of your demonstration, and therefore, a high-quality deliverable is expected from everyone.

Suggested solutions for incorporating visual aids:

- Use zoomed-in sections for clarity.
- Before taking the screenshot, change the section to landscape orientation and set the page size to A3 to improve the resolution of the charts.

Notes and instructions:

- The demonstrations are conducted with strict timeframes. Your tutors would assign you a presentation window and communicate the time to you.
- All team members are expected to be present and contributing during demonstrations. If a member is absent for unforeseen circumstances but the team members could confirm their collaboration, the entire team would receive the same assessment (i.e., the same mark for the task). However, team members who fail to attend the demonstration without valid reasons and/or fail to contribute to the collaboration and teamwork will not be eligible to receive marks for the demonstration.
- You **can not** request short extensions for the demonstration tasks.
- Your demonstration must not exceed 9 minutes. If you have questions to ask or require feedback, you will need to wait until all students have finished their demonstrations. Alternatively, you could attend a consultation session for questions and support.
- The marks awarded from your demonstration will constitute the final grade for this section. Without the demonstrations in the applied classes, the maximum grade your submitted work could achieve is a Pass or equivalent to 50% of the task's available score.
- The screenshot in your written component will be assessed only if your demonstration does not receive a Pass grade, the records indicate insufficient evidence presented, or there are any other exceptional circumstances.

3.5 Project Cost Management

3.5.1 Develop a comprehensive cost model of up to two pages¹ and a cost baseline for your project. Prepare a write up of all of your assumptions and references:

- a. Use the WBS developed in the previous deliverable for the cost estimation.
- b. Your Cost Estimate must detail the financial plan for the project, ensuring robust justification and alignment with industry practices:

¹ Consider an A4 page size!

- Labour Costs: Estimate the staffing expenses using appropriate benchmarks (e.g., Monash University's Enterprise Agreement and the Hays IT Contractor Rates Guide FY24/25). Provide justification for your estimates.
 - Materials & Equipment: Identify all necessary hardware, software, and other resources, along with their estimated costs.
 - Services & Vendors: Where applicable include anticipated expenses for third-party services and vendor contracts, with supporting evidence or industry data.
 - Contingency: Allocate a contingency reserve (typically 15–20%) to cover unforeseen expenses. Explain your rationale for the percentage chosen in the memo to management.
 - Overheads: Account for indirect costs such as administration, facility expenses, and other miscellaneous items.
 - Cost Estimation Methodology & Justifications: Describe the estimation approach (e.g., analogous, parametric, bottom-up) used in your analysis, and provide clear justifications for major cost items in the memo.
- c. The total estimate should be below the budget agreed on in your project charter (Task 3.2.2).
- d. Add a write up of maximum two pages detailing the cost estimates and their references (details that cannot be presented in a concise cost model), as well as any assumptions made for the estimation. This should complement and clarify your cost model.
- e. Cost Baseline: Present a cost baseline that outlines expected expenditures over the project lifecycle, indicating how costs will be monitored and controlled.

3.5.2 Write a memo about the cost model (written submission)

Write a one page memo to management elaborating your cost model and its elements including the approach to develop the model, your rationale for choosing the major items, and contingency reserves. Your memo should clearly and concisely communicate the cost model and demonstrate your understanding of the client's constraints, and expectations. If you have included a cost baseline, you should reflect on it in the memo and explain the rationale and reasoning behind it.

3.6 Project Risk Management

Demonstrate the process of developing a comprehensive Risk Management Plan for your chosen project, explain how risks were identified, analysed, prioritised and managed collaboratively. Steps to undertake:

1. Risk Identification
 - a. Brainstorm risks using techniques such as root cause analysis and scenario planning.

Note that the Assessment will take into consideration the diversity and variations of the risks documented in the Risk Register.

- b. Consider both internal and external risk factors, including technical, financial, and stakeholder risks.
 - c. Compile a Risk Register that includes at least 8 risks for the projects, detailing their sources, likelihood, and potential impact
2. Risk Analysis: Analyse the risks in the risk register to assess their likelihood and impact.
3. Risk Prioritisation: Develop and utilise a probability-impact matrix to prioritise risks, focusing on risks that could severely impact project outcomes. Justify your prioritisation decisions through team consensus.
4. Response Planning
 - a. Develop response plans for the risks identified in your Risk Register.
 - b. Ensure response plans are realistic and within scope.
 - c. *High Distinction task (for students pursuing HD)*: Prepare a time and cost analysis report for management, elaborating the implications and time/cost requirements to execute the risk responses plans.

3.7 Quality Management Plan

3.7.1 Objective

Develop a Quality Management Plan to ensure the project meets the desired stakeholder expectations and standards and aligns with the organisation's goals.

3.7.2 Instructions

Define FIVE Quality Objectives and Quality Standards:

- A. Clearly articulate five quality objectives of the project, ensuring they align with the overall project goals and stakeholder expectations. Define what “quality” means for your project.
- B. For each quality objective, identify at least two applicable standards relevant to your system (e.g. ISO 9001, WCAG, or discipline-specific guidelines). These standards or requirements must provide a basis for ensuring the project meets industry standards and regulatory requirements.
- C. For each quality objective, specify measurable criteria for assessing quality (e.g. defect rates, adherence to specifications, customer satisfaction scores). Ensure these metrics are linked to the identified quality standards and project objectives.

3.8 Stakeholder/Communication Management Plan

3.8.1 Objective

Develop a Stakeholder Register and Communication Matrix to support effective stakeholder engagement by defining communication expectations, preferred channels, and ensuring consistent communication throughout the project lifecycle.

3.8.2 Instructions

A. Stakeholder Register

- a. Identify at least **eight key stakeholders** for the project, including stakeholders from the project team, the client organisation, and other external parties.

B. Communication Matrix:

- a. Determine the communication needs for the project. Examples include meetings, emails, reports, dashboards, etc.
- b. While there is no minimum/maximum number of communication types/methods, make sure that you have identified at least one communication type/method for each stakeholder group.
- c. A stakeholder group or individual stakeholders may be recipients of more than one communication type/method.

C. Stakeholder Management and Engagement Plan:

- a. Develop a management and engagement plan for three key stakeholders who are not on the project team. The plan should address how their goals and expectations will be managed throughout the project lifecycle. Indicate their level of influence, interest and their current engagement level.
- b. Ensure you identify key stakeholders who have significant influence or a critical interest in the project but are not part of the project team.

4. Reflection on team collaboration and individual performance

4.1 Group reflection

This is a group task where you reflect on your team's collaboration while working on your project plans. You are expected to reflect on critical aspects of your collaboration mentioned in the working agreement (team charter) such as leadership, support and sharing feedback as well as conflict resolution.

Word Limit: 400 ± 10% words for the group reflection.

4.2 Individual reflection

This is an individual reflection for each member of the team. In this reflection, each student reflects on their personal experience while working on the project with their team. At the end of the report, you would evaluate your performance and conclude with a letter grade. You would also evaluate your team's performance and assign a letter grade to the team's performance.

All team members will add their individual reflections to the main report, including their names and student IDs. Your self-evaluation and team-evaluation could impact your overall assessment if deemed appropriate and justified by the assessors.

Use the following prompts to guide your reflection:

It is not compulsory to follow any specific reflective framework, though to reach a D or HD mark you would be clearly using a framework for reflective thinking, such as Gibbs' Reflective Cycle (or other credible reflection techniques/references), to structure and communicate your thoughts/experiences. The emphasis is on reflecting critically on your personal journey through the unit.

Word Limit: 250 ± 10% words for each individual reflection.

5. Completeness and correctness of statements; clarity of expressions

The report should contain clearly structured information that is focused on identifying and addressing all requirements of the deliverable with clear supporting information. The report should be well presented and include key elements of a succinct report such as a title or cover page, a table of contents, page numbers, appendices (if applicable), etc.

All sections of the report and the analyses and discussions are expected to demonstrate originality, creativity, and sophisticated thinking. The statements show an excellent understanding of the foundation of the unit and a strong capability to transform the theories into intellectual contributions.

6. Use of references

Students are expected to search for relevant extra readings and draw on suitable literature from academic publications as well as practitioner outlets. All sources of information must be fully and appropriately acknowledged using in-text citation and reference list. Use at least 10 references, 5 of which must be from peer reviewed academic journals or conference publications. The minimum 5 references excludes the IT Contractor Rates Guide by HAYS provided. The IT Contractor Rates Guide by HAYS should also be cited where appropriate.

The reference section **should use the American Psychological Association (APA)** style of referencing. IF you are unsure about referencing styles, you could reach out to Monash's library services and use their workshops and resources.

(APA 7th style: <https://guides.lib.monash.edu/apa-7>)

6.1 Falsified and fake references

If any of the references listed in the assignment are falsified, meaning that they are non-existent or include false information such as those made up by Generative AI, this section will be marked Zero and could potentially be reported as a case of academic misconduct.

7. Frequently Asked Questions (from past students)

Q: Do we submit anything in Week 2 or 3?

A: No. These are discussion-only weeks. But your idea must be ready by Week 4.

Q: Is the Gantt chart due in the report?

A: No separate upload. Show it in class (Week 6) and take a screenshot for your report.

Q: What is the difference between Memo and Charter?

A:

- Memo = short note to convince your sponsor (1 page)
- Charter = full internal plan with goals, risks, and justification (2–3 pages)

Q: Are all deliverables equal in marks?

A:

- Pitch = 10%
- Demo = 20%
- Full Report (includes memos, charter, scope, Gantt, etc.) = 70%

Q: Do we follow PMBOK 6 or 7?

A: PMBOK 7 is used in this unit. But we also use tools (like Gantt, WBS) from PMBOK 6 for practice.

8. Additional Resources

Use the following resources to support your research, analysis, and project planning. These sources cover project management standards and guidelines.

- **Project Management Institute (PMI):**

Access the PMBOK® Guide (7th Edition) and other PMI standards and guidelines for project planning, scope management, and cost estimation. URL: <https://www.pmi.org/pmbok-guide-standards>

- **Monash University Library:**

Utilise academic journals, books, and databases for case studies, research articles, and additional readings on project management.

URL: <https://library.monash.edu>

Business Justification and Project Charter

Key Resources:

1. PMI:

- PMI Practice Guide on Project Charters: Explains the role and structure of the project charter in aligning with strategic goals. PMI Library

2. PMBOK 6th Edition:

- Chapter 4.1: Develop Project Charter (pp. 75-82) (Outlines inputs, tools, and techniques for charter development, emphasising SMART objectives and stakeholder alignment.)

3. PMBOK 7th Edition:

- Principle 2: Stewardship and Principle 3: Team (pp. 12-15). (Connects project charters to organisational strategy and ethical considerations.)

4. Schwalbe (2018):

- Chapter 3: The Project Management Process (Provides step-by-step instructions for drafting a charter with examples tailored for IT projects.)

5. Brewer & Dittman (2018):

- Chapter 2: Creating a Project Charter (Detailed examples of project justifications, including cost-benefit analysis and strategic alignment.)

Work Breakdown Structure (WBS) and Gantt Charts

Key Resources:

1. PMI:

- Creating a WBS: PMI WBS Guide (Illustrates how to structure deliverables and tasks effectively.)

2. PMBOK 6th Edition:

- Chapter 5.4: Create WBS (pp. 157-166). (Process for creating a WBS, including decomposition techniques.)

- Section: Measurement Performance Domain (pp. 56-60). (Discusses integrating schedules like Gantt charts to track progress.)

- Chapter 6: Time Management (Detailed examples of Gantt charts and network diagrams for IT projects.)

3. Brewer & Dittman (2018):

- Chapter 6: Scheduling Techniques (Combines Gantt charts and critical path method for time management.)

Scope Management

Key Resources:

1. PMI:

- Defining Project Scope: PMI Scope Management (Comprehensive techniques for defining and controlling scope.)

2. PMBOK 6th Edition:

- Chapter 5: Scope Management (Explains processes like collecting requirements, defining scope, and creating a WBS.)

3. PMBOK 7th Edition:

- Section: Delivery Performance Domain (pp. 50-55) (Focus on delivering agreed-upon scope through adaptive methods.)

4. Schwalbe (2018):

- Chapter 5: Scope Management (Includes practical exercises for creating WBS and managing scope creep in IT projects.)

5. Brewer & Dittman (2018):

- Chapter 4: Defining the Project Scope (Strategies for establishing boundaries and handling exclusions.)

Quality Management

Key Resources:

- **PMI:**
 - *PMI Standards for Quality Management*: Includes assurance and control practices for ensuring deliverable quality.
- **ISO Standards:**
 - *ISO 9001*: Framework for establishing quality management systems and metrics.
 - *ISO/IEC 25010*: Standards for evaluating software product quality, if applicable.
- **PMBOK 6th Edition:**
 - Chapter 8: *Project Quality Management*
 - Explains quality planning, assurance, and control processes with examples.
- **PMBOK 7th Edition:**
 - Section: *Quality Performance Domain* (pp. 75-79)
 - Emphasis on continuous improvement and adaptive approaches.
- **Schwalbe (2018):**
 - Chapter 8: *Quality Management*
 - Hands-on exercises for defining quality metrics and implementing assurance processes.
- **Brewer & Dittman (2018):**
 - Chapter 7: *Quality Planning and Control*
 - Practical tools for setting standards and performing quality audits.

Cost Estimation and Planning

Key Resources:

1. PMI:

- Cost Management Practices: PMI Cost Estimation (Covers analogous, parametric, and bottom-up estimation methods.)

2. PMBOK 6th Edition:

- Chapter 7: Project Cost Management (Includes cost estimation tools and techniques, cost baseline, and budget control.)

3. PMBOK 7th Edition:

- Section: Planning Performance Domain (pp. 44-47) (Modern approaches to budgeting and cost alignment.)

4. Schwalbe (2018):

- Chapter 7: Cost Management (Explains IT-specific cost estimation challenges and contingency planning.)
- 5. Brewer & Dittman (2018):
 - Chapter 8: Cost Estimation Methods (Detailed walkthrough of estimating labor, materials, and vendor costs.)

Risk Management

Key Resources:

- **PMI:**
 - *PMI Practice Standard for Risk Management*: Comprehensive guidelines on identifying, analysing, and responding to risks.
 - PMI Risk Management Framework: Practical applications of risk assessment and mitigation strategies.
- **PMBOK 6th Edition:**
 - Chapter 11: *Project Risk Management*: Details processes like risk identification, qualitative/quantitative risk analysis, and response planning.
- **PMBOK 7th Edition:**
 - Section: *Uncertainty Performance Domain* (pp. 66-71): Focuses on managing risks in dynamic and adaptive environments.
- **Schwalbe (2018):**
 - Chapter 11: *Risk Management*: Real-world examples and techniques for identifying and mitigating IT project risks.
- **Brewer & Dittman (2018):**
 - Chapter 9: *IT-Specific Risks and Solutions*: Tools and methods tailored to technology-focused projects.